Miles D. Williams

Denison University, Data for Political Research
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EMPLOYMENT

Denison University, Visiting Assistant Professor 2022-present

EDUCATION

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign, Ph.D. Political Science 2022

Dissertation: "International Aid and Strategic Interdependence: How Common and Conflicting Foreign Policy Goals Shape the Supply of Foreign Aid"
Committee: Matthew S. Winters (chair), Xinyuan Dai, Robert Pahre, Robert Carroll

Eastern Illinois University, M.A. Political Science 2016

Greenville University, B.A. History & Political Science, Philosophy (*Summa Cum Laude*, with honors) 2015

RESEARCH

Peer Reviewed Publications (Ordered by Publication Date)

[9] "The Measurement of Christian Nationalism in Broader Perspective: A Systematic Reevaluation" (2026) in *Politics and Religion* with Paul A. Djupe, Brooklyn E. Walker, Anand E. Sokhey, Jacob R. Neiheisel, and Andrew R. Lewis

[8] "Aid for Nonaggression." (2025) in *Conflict Management and Peace Science*. (pdf version here)

[7] "An Undergraduate Degree in 'Data for Political Research': High in Demand and Student Value but Low in Supply." (2025) With Paul Djupe in *PS: Political Science and Politics*.

[6] "Connect First, then Suppress: Chinese vs. Western Communication Development Projects and Internet Freedom." (2025) With Yujeong Yang, Lucie Lu, and Xinle Jia in *Studies in Comparative International Development*.

[5] "Attention Versus Handshakes: Pathways of Influence in China's Foreign Aid and Loans." (2024) With Lucie Lu in *Journal of International Development*.

[4] "Elusive Collaboration? The Determinants of Lead Donorship in International Development." (2024) in *The Review of International Organizations*.

[3] "How Reducing Documentation Burdens Impacts Equity in Program Access: The Case of Small Business Covid-19 Relief Funding." (2023) With Elizabeth Bell and Heather Kappes in *Public Administration Review*.

[2] "Gender in the Pulpit: The Differences in Speaking Style for Men and Women." (2019) With Ryan Burge in *The Journal of Communication and Religion*.

[1] "Is Social Media a Digital Pulpit? How Evangelical Leaders Use Twitter to Encourage the Faithful and Publicize Their Work." (2019) With Ryan Burge in *Journal of Religion, Media, and Digital Culture*.

Book Chapters (Ordered by Publication Date)

[2] "World Bank." (2023) With Matthew Winters in *Handbook of International Organizations: Theories, Concepts, and Empirical Insights*. Eds. Katja Freistein, Julia Leininger, and Silke Weinlich. De Gruyter Oldenbourg.

[1] "Illinois 10th Congressional District: Re-rematch in Chicago Suburbs." (2018) With Jeffrey Ashley in *The Roads to Congress 2016*. Eds. Sean D. Foreman and Marcia L. Godwin. Palgrave Macmillan]

Selected Works in Progress (Alphabetical Order)

"Alignment, Aid, and Aggression: Bringing Strategic Interdependence into the Two-Good Theory of Foreign Policy" [Working Paper]

"An Actuary Walks into the War Room: How a Model from Actuarial Science Can Help Forecast the Deadliness of War" [Working Paper]

"An Order of Magnitude: Insights on International Order Collapse from a Dynamic Network Model of Order Formation" [Working Paper] [PDF]

"Leaders Unleashed: The Importance of Constraints on Hawkish Leaders" [Working Paper]

Conferences (Ordered by Attendance Date)

"Alignment, Aid, and Aggression: Bringing Strategic Interdependence into the Two-Good Theory of Foreign Policy" ISA March 2026

"Leaders Unleashed: The Importance of Constraints on Hawkish Leaders" ISA March 2026

"Aid, Aggression, and Alignment: A Test of the Two-Good Theory in Equilibrium" MPSA April 2025

"An Actuary Walks into the War Room: How a Model from Actuarial Science Can Help Forecast the Deadliness of War" MPSA April 2025

"Aid for Nonaggression: Donor Security Strategy After the Cold War" MPSA April 2025

"Aid for Nonaggression: Donor Security Strategy After the Cold War" APSA September 2024

"Connect First, then Suppress: Do Communication Aid Projects Erode Internet Freedom?" MPSA April 2024

"Foreign Aid and Investment Protection," ISAM Nov. 2023

"Foreign Aid and Investment Protection," APSA Aug. 2023

"Foreign Aid and Investment Protection," MPSA April 2023

"A Strategic Political Economy of Aid," PEIO July 2022

"Friends Get more Money, Attention, and Handshakes: Xinhua, Diplomacy, and Chinese Foreign Aid," AidData Roundtable June 2022

"Competition and Buck-passing in the Political Economy of Aid," MPSA April 2022

Public Scholarship

I am the author of *Foreign Figures*, a weekly newsletter offering data-driven takes on foreign affairs.

I have contributed to *Democracy Paradox*.

I also have contributed to *Religion in Public*.

I also write about various statistical and R-related things on my personal blog hosted on my professional website.

SOFTWARE

Tools

Expert: R & RStudio
Proficient: Posit Assistant, GitHub, & Latex
Basic: Stata & Python

R Packages Developed

`{actuwar}` - Offers a user-friendly API for estimating inverse Burr models of extreme events, with applied examples for war fatalities.

`{coolor}` - Tools to make setting and applying custom color palettes with `ggplot` more streamlined.

`{oesr}` (with Ryan T. Moore) - For visualizing the results from randomized controlled trials using the Office of Evaluation Sciences' recommended style guide.

`{seerrr}` - Tools that simplify the process of doing Monte Carlo and computational power analyses.

`{ggregtab}` - Uses `ggplot()` under the hood to generate regression tables.

TEACHING

Denison University

DA 101: Introduction to Data Analytics
DPR 101: Data Visualization for Political Research
DPR 190: War, Wealth, and World Politics
DPR 201: Data and Research Design for Social Impact
DPR 390: Death, Destruction, and Data

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

Intro to International Relations (Independent Instructor)
Intro to Political Science (Teaching Assistant)
UIUC Math Camp
- Probability in R
- Integrals
- Linear Regression
- Loops
- Version Control

OTHER EMPLOYMENT

US Office of Evaluation Sciences

Associate Fellow (methods specialist) 2020-2023

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

Research Assistant

Cara Wong	2020-2022
Matthew S. Winters	2018-2020

Teaching Assistant

Kostas Kourtikakis	2017

Eastern Illinois University

Research Assistant for Jeffrey Ashley	2016
Presidential Graduate Assistant	2015-2016

AWARDS AND GRANTS

University of Illinois at Urbana-Champaign

Kathleen L. Burkholder Prize for Best Dissertation	2023
William Bernhard Award for Best Dissertation Prospectus	2021
Rita and Leonard Ogren Award for Academic Excellence	2018

Eastern Illinois University

Robert and Kathryn Augustine Distinguished Master's Thesis Award	2018
Williams Travel Grant	2016

SERVICE

Reviewer

American Political Science Review
British Journal of Politics and International Relations
Journal of Politics
Review of International Organizations
International Interactions
Political Studies Review
Development Studies Research
Frontiers

International Relations Graduate Workshop, Coordinator 2020-2021

Graduate Methods Committee

Member	2019-2021
Chair	2020

UIUC Political Science Graduate Student Association, Board Member 2019-2020